

Thomas Haferlach

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PROFILES	 LinkedIn  GitHub  Artist Page
SUMMARY	AI researcher and entrepreneur with expertise in generative AI and LLMs, including developing and training models. Founder of Pollinations.AI, an open-source platform for generative AI. Experienced in developing and scaling AI platforms, APIs, and community building.
WORK EXPERIENCE	9/2025 TILL 8/2026 Software Developer at Deel II GmbH, for Myceli AI Berlin, Germany 3/2023 TILL 8/2024 Senior Machine Learning Specialist at PIXELYNX Berlin, Germany · Remote Led development of the generative AI platform Korus, focusing on audio and video. Implemented APIs and optimized machine learning models for real-time performance, including efficient inference. 1/2022 TILL 3/2023 Founder & Machine Learning Specialist at Pollinations.AI Berlin, Germany Founded and developed an open-source generative AI platform. Built text and image APIs, model integrations and developer tooling, and supported the project's open-source community. 1/2020 TILL 12/2022 AI Visualization Specialist at Cultural Institutions Berlin, Germany & Amsterdam, Netherlands Developed AI-driven future visualization projects for the Humboldt Forum and Amsterdam Dance Event. 6/2019 TILL 1/2022 Machine Learning Specialist at Pixtunes Berlin, Germany Machine Learning Lead for the Pixtunes orchestra, an AI-based music production system. Secured €1.2 million in EU research funding. 9/2018 Foresight Researcher & AI Visualization Specialist at Envisioning Remote Researched future trends of AI and technologies impacting sustainability. Led development of AI-driven future visualization projects. 3/2018 TILL 6/2018 AI and Art Presenter & Performer at MUTEK, Frontière IA & transmediale Montreal, Canada & Berlin, Germany Presented on AI in art and performed a musical piece using smartphones to create musical swarm intelligence. 3/2008 TILL 3/2016 Freelance Developer at Various Companies Brazil Developed interactive installations using machine learning, computer vision, and data visualization. 10/2006 TILL 2/2007 Software Engineer at Amazon Development Centre Scotland Edinburgh, United Kingdom Agile development of backend tooling, A/B testing and data mining for sales optimization.

EDUCATION	1/2001 TILL 1/2006	The University of Edinburgh: Artificial Intelligence and Computer Science			
		Bachelor of Science with <i>First class honors</i>			
		Thesis: Evolving Neural Models of Path Integration			
PUBLICATIONS	3/2007	Evolving a Neural Model of Insect Path Integration T. Haferlach, J. Wessnitzer, M. Mangan & B. Webb			
		Adaptive Behaviour 15(3)			
		Developed a neural model of insect path integration using a genetic algorithm, and implemented it on a robot.			
AWARDS & PROJECTS		AI-Generated Art and Music Installations			
		Led several AI-driven art and music projects showcasing advanced AI techniques in creative contexts, including 'Marvin's Dream' (AI-generated narrative with spatial sound design), 'Cohabitation' (AI-enhanced urban planning visualization), and 'Traverse' (a project by Google featuring a VR experience with AI-generated soundscape).			
LANGUAGES		English (Native speaker) German (Native speaker) Portuguese (Full professional) French (Basic conversational)			
SKILLS		Software Engineering: Distributed Computing, Full Stack Development, API Development, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, Git, Docker, Kubernetes			
		Machine Learning: Deep Learning, Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLMs), Diffusion Models, Computer Vision, Natural Language Processing, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Prompt Engineering, Fine-tuning, Model Serving, API Development, Data Processing Pipelines, Data Visualization			
		Cloud Computing & AI Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure, OpenAI API, Hugging Face, Replicate			
		Soft Skills: Open Source Project Management, Community Building, Technical Leadership, Cross-functional Collaboration, Problem Solving, Communication with Technical and Non-technical Audiences			